

Container Pools Co.

Turn a rusted shipping container into a backyard luxury pool.

What It Is

A manufacturing business that converts used 20ft and 40ft shipping containers into modern, plunge-style swimming pools. Each container is cut, structurally reinforced, lined with a waterproof membrane, then fitted with LED lighting, entry steps, and a full pump-and-filtration system. The finished product ships as a near-complete unit that a customer can have craned into their yard and swimming-ready in days rather than the months an in-ground pool takes.

How It Makes Money

You buy a cheap used container and a few thousand dollars of components, then sell the finished pool for a large multiple of your input cost. Buyers are homeowners who want a pool without a \$50K+ in-ground excavation, vacation-rental and Airbnb owners adding a high-value amenity, gyms and physiotherapy clinics wanting a cold-plunge or lap pool, and event/rental companies. You can also sell add-ons: heaters, covers, decking kits, and annual maintenance contracts.

Startup Costs

- Used 20ft shipping container: \$1,500-\$3,000 (40ft: \$3,000-\$5,000)
- Steel reinforcement, bracing and structural steel: \$800-\$1,500
- Waterproof liner / fiberglass or PVC membrane: \$600-\$1,200
- Pump, sand/cartridge filter, plumbing kit: \$700-\$1,500 (sourced on Alibaba: complete pool filtration combo \$250-\$450/unit landed)
- LED lights, steps, ladder, skimmer hardware (Alibaba per-set import): \$150-\$350/unit landed
- Welder, plasma cutter, grinder, basic tooling: \$2,000-\$4,000 (one-time)
- Workshop / yard rental: \$800-\$2,000/month
- Crane/delivery (per job, often passed to customer): \$400-\$900
- Insurance, LLC, permits, branding: \$1,500-\$3,000

Realistic launch budget: \$12,000-\$20,000 for tools plus your first 1-2 builds.

The Numbers

- All-in material + component cost per pool: roughly **\$5,000-\$7,000** (container, steel, liner, filtration, lights, labor allowance)
- Sell price: **\$18,000-\$28,000** installed (market sits well below a \$50K in-ground pool, which is your selling point)
- Profit per unit: **\$11,000-\$20,000** before overhead
- Build time: 2-3 weeks per unit; with a small crew you can run 2-4 in parallel
- Realistic monthly projection (months 4-12): 3-5 pools/month -> **\$35,000-\$80,000/month gross profit**, netting **\$20,000-\$50,000/month** after rent, labor, delivery, and marketing.

How To Start

1. Source one used container locally (Craigslist, container depots, or freight yards) and rent a small fabrication yard with power.
2. Buy or borrow a welder, plasma cutter, and grinder; bulk-order filtration, LED, and step kits from Alibaba to lock in low per-unit costs.
3. Build your first prototype pool end-to-end and document every step with photos and video.
4. Pressure-test it for 72 hours, run the filtration, and confirm zero leaks before showing anyone.
5. Shoot a strong before/after reel and list the prototype for sale at your target price.
6. Set up a simple website and lead form (host on Coolify), with clear pricing tiers: 20ft plunge, 40ft lap, and premium LED/heated.
7. Use deposits (40-50% upfront) to fund each subsequent build so you grow without large capital.

Where To Get Customers

- Instagram and TikTok before/after reels (this concept goes viral on visuals alone)
- Facebook Marketplace and local Facebook home/pool groups
- Google Ads on "shipping container pool" and "above ground pool near me"
- Partnerships with landscapers, deck builders, and hot-tub dealers for referrals
- Airbnb/short-term-rental host communities and property managers
- Home and garden trade shows with a live demo unit on a trailer

Pro Tips

- Pre-fabricate and reinforce containers in a batch, then customize finishes per order. This cuts build time and lets you quote faster than competitors.
- Sell the crane delivery as a separate line item and partner with one reliable local crane operator. It keeps your quoted price low and protects margin.
- Offer a "rent-to-own" or financing option through a third-party lender. Most pool buyers care about monthly payment, not sticker price, and this dramatically widens your market.